

whatweretheythinking.com



<http://john.cavaliers.org/boring.html>

cent, forget a fortune? But it takes all kinds, and Ingram is one of those. He is rational in his thought, grammatically correct in his writing (although for some reason he hates capital letters), and has enough reasons to keep the world's most boring site alive at all times since its "founding" in 1996. Is that why his site has now been translated into 12 languages including Finnish, French, Swedish, Norwegian, and, hold your breath, ladies and gentlemen, Pig Latin. World War II is obviously history since here we have a German as well as a Hebrew translation sitting right next to each other. The site, Ingram informs us, was created in DOS-edit (yes, you can do that!), and was meant to escape the humongous GIF-animated and Flash sites. This is where you come for a break after spending hours and hours visiting various sites. A sort of virgin beach in the Seychelles after visiting the crowds of New York, Bangkok, Singapore and Hong Kong.

Some people are born boring; others, like John Ingram, thrust boredom upon the rest of the world. And so, as we tread upon the gargantuan bog called the Internet, we slip and wonder: Why? Why did John Ingram create a site that has nothing but just 413 (exactly) words of text? Why did he create a site that has no meaning, no reason to exist, and no way to earn him even a

A CASE OF TOO MUCH

"Digital Obesity" In The UK

If you could equate the data stored on devices with physical weight—for example, equate a gigabyte of data to a truckload of paper—then, reports the BBC, Britons are growing "digitally obese", meaning, they are becoming inveterate data-hoarders. "Gadget lovers are so hungry for digital data many are carrying the equivalent of 10 trucks full of paper in 'weight'," according to the story on the BBC News website.

The Toshiba study that came to the "digitally obese" finding said that more than 60 per cent of Britons kept 1,000 to 2,000 music files on their devices.

"Britain has become a nation of information

hoarders with a ferocious appetite for data," said Martin Larsson, general manager of Toshiba's European storage device division. "As storage capabilities increase and the features and functionalities of mobile devices expand to support movie files and entire libraries of multimedia content, we will all become virtually obese," he told the BBC News Web site.

"Consumers are driving the move towards smaller devices that have greater functionality, and industry is trying to keep up," said Larsson. "People are looking for more than just phone calls and text messages—they want things like Web browsing, e-mailing, photos, music and more."

Several factors are fuelling this increase in the amount of data that people are storing: falling cost per gigabyte, increasing capacities of hard drives and other data devices, and the growing ease of file transfer from device to device. ■

Compiled by Ram Mohan Rao

Blog WATCH

Here's taking a look at a few riveting posts from the world of blogs. This month, we look at Desktop Search, just after Microsoft released its beta version. But then, what exactly does "beta" mean? Robert Scoble fires off on *that* topic. Then, there's a sobering post for Mac users who think *nix makes their machines more secure. And finally, a history Professor's blog on the Middle East.

Michael Gartenberg
<http://snipurl.com/bejg>

Desktop Search

There's a lot of buzz around desktop search these days, with Google having released its version some time ago, and Microsoft releasing its beta version a few days ago. It turns out that Microsoft's desktop search will just be an interface for a feature that is already there in Windows XP and 2000, but that's a different matter. Gartenberg asserts that Desktop Search is not a new thing, and that what's interesting now is "the relationship of these things to web search and the implications."

Robert Scoble
<http://snipurl.com/bejh>

Does "beta" mean anything any more?

Robert Scoble works at Microsoft as a "technical evangelist." Here, he offers his personal opinions on a variety of things. For example, there's a Desktop Search reviewer's guide, a list of news search tools he uses, and so on. In "Does beta mean anything any more," he laments: "Google calls everything beta. Heck, ICQ has been calling itself beta since 1996."

Look around you for all the betas—for example, Amazon even calls its new stores, such as sports equipment, "beta." So—what does "beta" mean to you? Head to Scoble's blog and have your say.

drunkenbatman
<http://snipurl.com/beji>

Yin & Yang

Interesting snippets from this blog post: "The vast majority of Malware, viruses and worms doesn't come about via technical inferiority, or even the other platforms being inherently more secure."

"Something that can be hard for Mac users to wrap their heads around is that when you get down to it, Windows and OS X are more alike than they are different."

"The big thing Mac users crow about with regards to OS X is 'It's based on *nix, so it's much more secure.' That's fine to say, but what does it mean?" It's a long post, but worth reading.

Juan Cole
<http://www.juancole.com/>

Thoughts on the Middle East, History, and Religion

"Will there ever be peace in the Middle East?" is what we all want to know. Here's a take by a Professor of History on a wide range of subjects, complete with a historical perspective on what goes on in the region and why—and what role religion has to play in all of that.

Some of his recent posts: "Iraqi Jews before 1948," "Opinion Polls in Iraq", "Assassination by Poisoning a Chancy Matter", and others of interest in these times. A must-read for those interested in the Middle East, and want an informed, disinterested opinion.